

Topic Area 1: Plan digital games

Teaching content

Exemplification

1.1 Types, characteristics and conventions of digital games

Types of digital game and their characteristics

- 2D arcade
- 3D RPG
- MMO
- Simulation
- Game-based learning
- Augmented/virtual reality

Conventions and styles of digital games

- Game genres and their conventions
 - action
 - sports
 - role playing game
 - quest
 - strategy
- Gameplay styles
 - first person or third person
 - selectable views
 - arcade-style
 - top-down views
- Visual styles
 - theme
 - fantasy
 - animated/cartoon
 - photorealism/VR

To include:

- Characteristics of each digital game type
- Digital game types which are most appropriate for specific target audience groups
- Digital game types which are most appropriate for particular platforms
- Applying the concept of MVP (Minimum Viable Product) when planning games to ensure audience engagement

Does not include:

- The technical features of game platform hardware

To include

- Key conventions of each genre and style, how they differ from each other and the types of games which are best suited to each
- How games increase in difficulty or complexity to maintain player engagement through multiple levels, spin-offs, side missions
- How different features of games appeal to different audience types

Does not include:

- Investigation of existing games, user feedback reviews, games which are rated or certificated as 18 or for adults only

Unit R099: Digital games

Game objectives

- ☐ Quest
- ☐ Collect
- ☐ Race
- ☐ Shoot
- ☐ Strategy or tactics of battle
- ☐ Escape
- ☐ Survive
- ☐ Build
- ☐ Problem-solve
- ☐ Score
- ☐ Beat the clock

Creativity in digital games

- ☐ Originality
- ☐ Imaginative design
- ☐ Derivative design

To include:

- Distinguishing features of each type of game objective
- Identifying objectives and deciding which are the most appropriate for target audiences and/or platforms
- Choosing game objectives which make games immersive or engaging/appealing

Does not include:

- Extended testing of games, games which are rated or certificated as 18 or for adults only, non-digital games (fairground/arcade machines/board games)

To include:

- How original work differs from adaptations to existing designs
- How imaginative work can be derivative
- How to balance following conventions with originality/imagination to produce creative products